

PAKISTAN STUDIES

The Aligarh Movement & Establishment of Congress

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- **The Aligarh Movement**

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- **The War of Independence 1857 ended in disaster for the Muslims. The British believed that the Muslims were responsible for the war of 1857 and therefore, they were subjected to brutal punishment and merciless revenge.**

Contributions of Sir Syed Ahmed Khan

- **1859 Established School at Muradabad.**
- **1860 Published Loyal Mohammadans of India.**
- **1863 Established Victoria School at Ghazipur.**
- **1864 Established Scientific Society at Ghazipur.**
- **1870 He issued Tahzeb-ul-Ikhlaq (magazine).**
- **1870 Published Khutbat-e-Ahmaddia in reply to William Muir's book 'Life of Mahomet'.**
- **1872 Made Mohammadan College Committee.**
- **1876 Retired from services.**

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- **1883 established Mohammadan Association.**
- **1886 Established All India Mohammadan Educational Conference.**
- **1887 he demanded from government that Dar-ul-Tarjuma be established so that the authentic work could be translated into Urdu for the benefit of university students.**
- **1893 established the Mohammadan Anglo Oriental Defence Association.**
- **1898 on 27th March, died at Aligarah.**

IDEAS OF SIR SYED AHMED KHAN

The ideas of Sir Syed may be summed up as following:

- To create an atmosphere of mutual understanding between the British government and the Muslims
- To motivate the Muslims to learn Western education
- To persuade Muslims to give up from agitational politics.

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- **Establishment of
Indian National Congress**

Historical prospects

- The British foresaw the situation resulting in another rebellion on the pattern of the War of Independence. To avoid such a situation, the British decided to provide an outlet to the local people where they could discuss their political problems. In order to achieve this goal, Allan Octavian Hume, a retired British civil servant, had a series of meetings with Lord Dufferin.

Political Solution of the problems

- On his return from Britain, A.O. Hume consulted the local Indian leaders and started working towards the establishment of an Indian political organization. He invited the convention of the Indian National Union, an organization he had already formed in 1884, to Bombay in December 1885.

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- Seventy delegates, most of whom were lawyers, educationalists and journalists, attended the convention in which the Indian National Congress was established. This first session of Congress was presided over by Womesh Chandra Banerjee and he was also elected as the first president of the organization.

Objectives of Indian National Congress

- To seek the cooperation of all the Indians in its efforts.
- Try to form national unity and eradicate the concepts of race, creed and provincial / regional disparity.
- Discuss and solve the social problems of the country.
- To request the government, give more shares to the locals in administrative affairs.

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- **As time went by, the Congress changed its stance and apparently became the biggest opposition to the British government.**

Reaction of Muslims on creation of Congress

- **Muslims opposed the creation of Congress and refused to participate in its activities. Out of the 70 delegates who attended the opening session of the Congress, only two were Muslims. Sir Syed Ahmad Khan, who was invited to attend the Bombay session, refused the offer.**

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- **Sir Syed also urged the Muslims to withdraw from the Congress activities and predicted that the party would eventually become a Hindu party and would only look after the interests of the Hindus. Syed Ameer Ali, another important Muslim figure of the era, also refused to join Indian National Congress.**

THANK YOU